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A METHODOLOGY NOTE

How Claude Captures Human Thought

On transcripts, voice memos, meeting notes, and why CAQ keeps humans at the centre

CroquetClaude
for the Croquet Association of Queensland

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IN BRIEF

Croquet's growth depends on human judgement — what clubs need, what members enjoy, where the game should go next. This note explains how CroquetClaude takes the rambly thoughts that come out of meetings, voice memos, and emails, and turns them into a searchable record of what humans actually said. AI organises the record. Humans decide.

1. Abstract

When a CAQ committee member rambles into a phone recorder, sends a long email, or speaks at a meeting, three things usually happen. The good thoughts get buried in the length. The half-formed ones get filtered out by the speaker before they are heard. And the whole conversation gets summarised into something blander than what was actually said. This note describes a different approach. CroquetClaude treats human input as primary-source material — the holy grail. Every distinct idea is extracted without filtering, evaluated on its own merits, and stored in a database that any future Claude session can search. The result is an institutional memory that grows with every conversation, and an AI that gets more useful to CAQ the more humans actually talk to it.

KEYWORDS *capture* · *voice memo* · *stream of consciousness* · *meeting notes* · *Open Brain* · *primary source* · *CAQ AI policy*

Methods note. Worked example throughout draws from a real session on the sixth of May 2026: a long email Wade Hart drafted to John Reynolds, the CAQ president, was processed by the workflow described in section three.

Disclosure. CroquetClaude is the AI assistant for CAQ's growth consultancy. This note was written by CroquetClaude with Wade Hart's editorial direction.

2. The Method

The workflow has three phases, and the order matters. *Extract* first, with no filtering. *Evaluate* each thread on its own. *Store* the results so the next conversation starts with more context than this one had.

In the extract phase, every distinct idea in the source material gets pulled out as its own thread. A voice memo, a long email, a set of whiteboard photos, a meeting transcript — all of it gets the same treatment. The rule is simple: no thread is dismissed as small talk on the first pass. A throwaway line about a venue often turns out to be the most useful sentence in a thirty-minute conversation. A grumble about a process is a gap in club support. A question someone asked but no one answered is a research item.

2.1 *Evaluating each thread*

The evaluate phase takes each thread and asks four things of it. What is this idea, in its strongest form? Why did the speaker raise it — what need does it serve? Does anything already exist that solves it? And finally: act now, research more, park, or kill — and if act now, what are the next three concrete steps?

The store phase is where most AI assistants quietly fail. CroquetClaude keeps a structured database — Open Brain — that holds every captured thought with its origin, type, and importance. Open Brain is searchable by meaning, not just keyword. When a future session asks what Marilyn thinks about coaching policy, or what was decided at the March committee meeting, or where the idea about junior tournaments came from, the answer comes from primary sources — what humans actually said — not from the AI's general knowledge or its guesses.

The whole pipeline runs on plain text. Every file is human-readable. Wade Hart can open any of them in Obsidian, edit them, and the changes flow through. Nothing is locked inside an AI's session memory.

3. Why It's Useful

The most expensive thing in any volunteer-run organisation is the cognitive overhead of remembering. Who said what, when, in which meeting, with what reasoning behind it. CAQ has decades of institutional memory living in heads that are not always available, in inboxes that are not always searched, and in minutes that are not always read.

This workflow does one specific job: it makes the act of capture cheap, and the act of recall reliable. A committee member can ramble into a phone recorder for ten minutes and have the contents extracted into discrete threads, evaluated, and filed — all in the time it takes to make a cup of tea.

KEY FINDING · 1

The cognitive bottleneck in CAQ's work is not making decisions. It is producing the raw thought that decisions are made from. Capture removes that bottleneck — and once the bottleneck is gone, every subsequent decision is better-informed than it would otherwise have been.

The second-order effect is more interesting than the first. Once enough thought is captured, the database itself becomes useful in ways the original speakers did not anticipate. A pattern emerges across three clubs that no single committee member would have noticed alone. A volunteer's offhand comment from a year ago becomes the answer to today's question. The institutional memory stops being a function of who is in the room and starts being a function of who has ever spoken to the system.

The third effect is on the AI itself. The more Claude knows about what CAQ actually wants — in CAQ's own words, not paraphrased — the more useful Claude becomes at every subsequent task. Drafting an email, building a flyer, briefing a stakeholder: every output is improved by primary-source grounding. The capture flywheel is not optional infrastructure; it is what makes the rest of the assistance work.

4. How It Helps CAQ

CAQ's strategic position on AI ought to be straightforward. Humans decide. AI does the office work. Every artifact CroquetClaude produces — every email, briefing, flyer, blog post — should advance one of CAQ's six aims, and every decision about which aim to advance, and how, comes from a human.

This is not just a preference. It is built into the architecture. Captured human thoughts have their own database. They are tagged as primary source. They are weighted higher than anything Claude generates. When a future session has to choose between a remembered decision Wade made and an inferred decision the AI thinks is sensible, the remembered one wins.

> *Humans do human things — enjoying croquet, and making decisions about its future. AI is here to replace the office work.*
>
> WADE HART · MAY 2026

Practically, this means three things for CAQ. First, every committee meeting becomes more valuable: a transcript or a set of notes processed through this pipeline yields a structured record that the next meeting can draw from. Second, every external conversation — a phone call with a club president, an email exchange with a coach, a venue visit — can be captured the same way. The cost of capture has been driven down to "ramble at your phone for ten minutes". Third, CAQ's public position on AI has a clean answer when asked. We use AI for office work. Humans decide.

The steering document John Reynolds is preparing is the natural place for this position to land. Once it is written, the ground rule for every future CAQ AI use is set: humans bring the thought, AI organises it. The capture workflow is the practical infrastructure that makes that principle hold.

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